OBOR reflects China's interest, as the world's biggest trading state in reducing the costs of transporting goods, but other exporters will also benefit. Similarly, China seeks to secure its energy supply through new pipelines, as China is now the world's largest energy consumer and oil importer. The OBOR land initiative is directed toward Central Asia, encompassing the entire route of the old overland trading route known as the Silk Road, from Asia to the Middle East and North Africa. The Maritime Silk Road is planned to run from China's coast to Europe, through the South China Sea and the Indian Ocean in one direction and from China's coast to the South Pacific in the other direction. Xi initiated the Silk Road Fund with an initial commitment of $40 billion. Planned and existing projects now exceed $900 billion, and the stated goal of OBOR may reach $4 trillion in financed projects.[128] Like the AIIB, OBOR's investment philosophy is described as "based on market principles, international practice, and professional standard[s], raising the bar for China to harmonize its approach to globalization."[129] Moreover, both have been considered complementary as "an international economic cooperation project [that] will produce influence on [the] regional and global order."[130]

The AIIB was officially founded in 2015 with fifty-seven members. The bank focuses on lending to infrastructure projects in Asia. Thirteen states from the wait list (including Canada) were approved to join the bank in March 2017, bringing its total membership to 70, leaving the United States and Japan as the only major G7 holdouts. At its annual meeting in June 2016, representatives from more than eighty countries attended. Its member countries have subscribed to the entire $100 billion planned initial capital for the AIIB, and $20 billion of that has been paid already. The AIIB is moving forward with four lending projects totaling $509 million, all in Asia: creating a power grid in Bangladesh, improving slums in Indonesia, constructing a highway in Pakistan, and building roads in Tajikistan. Although these projects cost nearly $2.4 billon, the AIIB will cofinance them with the World Bank, the ADB, and the EBRD. Additional projects are likely in India and Pakistan.[131]

The establishment of the AIIB came as a challenge to the G7 powers.[132] The World Bank in recent decades had dropped its once-dominant focus on heavy infrastructure down to only about 10 percent of total lending, partly in order to focus on new priorities, including antipoverty lending and rural development, and partly in response to environmental campaigners in the